

October

8



2004

Peace prize

It was announced that Kenyan activist Wangari Maathai would be awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for sustainable development in Kenya through her Green Belt Movement.

1906

Making waves

In London, UK, German hairdresser Karl Nessler showed off his new invention – a device that could make a person's hair wavy. It worked by heating the hair wrapped around its brass rollers, resulting in wavy or curly hair.

Microwave oven

1945

US physicist Percy L. Spencer applied for a patent for the world's first microwave oven. He thought of cooking food with microwaves after seeing a chocolate bar melt near a radar machine.



Also on this day

1871 The Peshtigo fire – the deadliest forest fire on record – burned around 1.2 million acres (490,000 hectares) of land in Wisconsin, USA.

1978 Using a speedboat, Australian motorboat racer Ken Warby became the first person to travel at 483 kph (300 mph) on water.

2008 Scientists revealed the discovery of around 270 new marine species near Tasmania.

Born this day

1910 Kirk Alyn, US actor. He was the first actor to play Superman on screen for a live-action film.

